

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAikulAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – S.R 1 THIRD LEVEL

Marks : 15

Name :

Duration : 30 Minutes

Exam No. :

Extract-Based Comprehensions with Answers

Extract 1

"The corridor I was in began angling left and slanting downward and I thought that was wrong, but I kept on walking. All I could hear was the empty sound of my own footsteps and I didn't pass a soul."

Questions:

1. What is the significance of the corridor angling downward? *Answer:* It represents Charley's transition into a different realm, symbolizing escapism from reality.
2. Why does Charley think walking through the corridor feels wrong? *Answer:* Because it deviates from the familiar paths he knows in Grand Central Station.

Extract 2

"I turned toward the ticket windows knowing that here - on the third level at Grand Central - I could buy tickets that would take Louisa and me anywhere in the United States we wanted to go. In the year 1894."

Questions:

1. Why does Charley want tickets to Galesburg? *Answer:* He sees it as an idyllic, peaceful place away from the turmoil of modern life.
2. What does the reference to 1894 signify? *Answer:* It highlights Charley's longing for a simpler, stress-free era.

Extract 3

"But that's the reason, he said, and my friends all agreed. Everything points to it, they claimed. My stamp collecting, for example; that's a 'temporary refuge from reality.'"

Questions:

1. What does the psychiatrist imply by calling stamp collecting a "temporary refuge"? *Answer:* He suggests it reflects Charley's need to escape the anxieties of the modern world.
2. How does Charley defend his stamp collecting habit? *Answer:* By mentioning that it was started by his grandfather during peaceful times.

Extract 4

"The lights were dim and sort of flickering. Then I saw why; they were open-flame gaslights. There were brass spittoons on the floor, and across the station a glint of light caught my eye."

Questions:

1. How do the gaslights and brass spittoons contribute to the setting? *Answer:* They reinforce the historical ambiance of the 1890s.

2. Why does Charley find the third level fascinating? *Answer:* Because it offers a nostalgic escape to a bygone era.

Extract 5

"The note is signed Sam. At the stamp and coin store I go to, I found out that Sam bought eight hundred dollars' worth of old-style currency."

Questions:

1. What does the letter reveal about Sam's whereabouts? *Answer:* Sam successfully found the third level and traveled to 1894.
2. How does Charley feel upon discovering Sam's letter? *Answer:* He is hopeful and reassured that the third level exists.

Assertion-Reasoning Questions

1. **Assertion (A):** Charley believed he could travel to 1894 through the third level.
Reason (R): Charley wanted to escape the stress and insecurity of modern life.
Answer: a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. Explanation: Charley's longing for the third level stems from his need for escapism, driven by the challenges of the modern world.
2. **Assertion (A):** Charley's psychiatrist considered the third level an imagination.
Reason (R): He described it as a "waking-dream wish fulfillment."
Answer: a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. Explanation: The psychiatrist interprets Charley's experience as a psychological escape from reality.
3. **Assertion (A):** The clerk at the ticket counter refused Charley's money.
Reason (R): The currency Charley used was not valid in 1894.
4. **Answer: b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.** Explanation: The currency was valid for 1894, but it was "modern" in appearance, which aroused the clerk's suspicion.
5. **Assertion (A):** Sam successfully found the third level.
Reason (R): Sam used old-style currency to start a hay and grain business.
Answer: a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. Explanation: Sam used Charley's information to travel back to 1894 and settle there.
6. **Assertion (A):** Charley bought old currency to travel to the third level.
Reason (R): He believed old money would help him blend in with the past.
Answer: a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. Explanation: Charley believed that having currency from 1894 would ensure smooth transactions at the third level.
7. **Assertion (A):** Charley found the front page of *The World* newspaper in a library.
Reason (R): The newspaper matched the date Charley believed he visited the third level.
Answer: a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. Explanation: The discovery in the library validated Charley's belief about the existence of the third level.
8. **Assertion (A):** The third level had dim lighting and open-flame gaslights.
Reason (R): This setup was characteristic of the 1890s.
Answer: a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. Explanation: The features of the third level reflected the era Charley believed it belonged to.
9. **Assertion (A):** Charley and his wife Louisa stopped searching for the third level.

Reason (R): Louisa thought Charley's imagination was harmful.

Answer: b) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A.

Explanation: While Louisa was concerned, they resumed searching after discovering Sam's letter.

10. **Assertion (A):** Grand Central Station is described as constantly expanding like a tree.

Reason (R): Charley often got lost due to its complex layout.

Answer: a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. Explanation:

Charley's descriptions of Grand Central support his idea of its labyrinthine nature.

11. **Assertion (A):** The third level represents hope and escapism for Charley.

Reason (R): It offers a retreat to a world free from war and chaos.

Answer: a) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. Explanation:

Charley's longing for the third level underscores his desire for a serene, conflict-free life.

Competency-Based Short Questions with Answers

1. **What was Charley's psychiatrist's explanation of the third level?**

Answer: He described it as a "waking-dream wish fulfillment," reflecting Charley's need to escape modern life's stress.

2. **How did Charley end up on the third level?**

Answer: He accidentally took a wrong turn in Grand Central Station and entered an unfamiliar corridor.

3. **What evidence supports the existence of the third level?**

Answer: Sam's letter, postmarked 1894, confirms the third level's connection to the past.

4. **Why does Charley buy old-style currency?**

Answer: To use it on the third level to buy tickets to Galesburg in 1894.

5. **What emotions does Galesburg symbolize for Charley?**

Answer: Galesburg represents peace, simplicity, and a refuge from modern complexities.

6. **What does Sam's disappearance indicate in the story?**

Answer: It shows that Sam believed in the third level and chose to escape to 1894 permanently.

7. **How does the author blend fantasy with reality in the story?**

Answer: By intertwining realistic details like Grand Central Station with imaginative elements like the third level.

8. **What role does nostalgia play in Charley's journey?**

Answer: Nostalgia fuels Charley's longing for the third level as a means of escaping modern stress.

9. **How does Charley's stamp collection relate to the theme of escapism?**

Answer: It serves as a tangible link to the past and a temporary retreat from modern worries.

10. **What message does the story convey about coping with stress?**

Answer: The story emphasizes the need for constructive escapism and finding peace amidst life's challenges.

VALUE BASED SHORT Q/A FOR 2 MARKS

1. What message does the story convey about coping with modern-day stress? *Answer:*

It highlights the importance of escapism and constructive outlets like hobbies or nostalgia to alleviate the pressures of modern life.

2. How does Charley's longing for 1894 reflect human emotions?

Answer: It reflects the universal desire for peace and simplicity in a world full of chaos and insecurity.

3. What does the third level symbolize in Charley's life?

Answer: The third level symbolizes hope, escapism, and the yearning for an ideal, stress-free past.

4. How does Sam's choice to remain in 1894 demonstrate human aspirations?

Answer: It shows the desire to live in a serene and fulfilling environment free from the burdens of modernity.

5. What role does nostalgia play in the story?

Answer: Nostalgia acts as a powerful escape mechanism, helping Charley and Sam connect with a simpler, more peaceful time.

6. What can we learn from Charley's belief in the third level?

Answer: It teaches us the value of persistence and hope in seeking peace and contentment.

7. How does Louisa's reaction show the importance of emotional support?

Answer: Her worry and eventual decision to join Charley in his search reflect the importance of supporting loved ones in their pursuits.

8. What does the discovery of Sam's letter teach us about friendship?

Answer: True friendship involves understanding and supporting each other's desires and aspirations, no matter how unconventional they might be.

9. What does Charley's stamp collection signify about human tendencies?

Answer: It shows the human tendency to hold onto the past as a refuge from the challenges of the present.

10. How does the story emphasize the balance between reality and imagination?

Answer: It illustrates that imagination can serve as a vital escape, but it must be balanced with an acceptance of reality for growth and resilience.

Long Q/A Samples (Answers are given with sub headings for your best understanding. You need not use them in your answers)

1. Value-Based Question

Question: How does the story *The Third Level* teach us about balancing modern life's stress?

Answer: Introduction: Jack Finney's *The Third Level* is a profound reflection on coping with modern life's complexities and challenges. The story highlights the human tendency to seek comfort and peace amidst chaos.

Content: Charley's journey to the third level symbolizes the universal need for escapism. His longing for the serene world of 1894 serves as a reminder that modern life, with its insecurities and stress, often leads individuals to nostalgic pursuits. His psychiatrist's explanation of "waking-dream wish fulfillment" aligns with the idea of escapism as a coping mechanism. Charley's stamp collection also reflects this desire to reconnect with the past, finding solace in simpler times. Through his experiences, the story suggests the importance of constructive outlets like hobbies and dreams to balance life's demands.

Conclusion: The story emphasizes that while escapism can be a temporary refuge, it is essential to face reality with resilience. By blending fantasy with practical life lessons, Finney encourages readers to find peace within themselves while navigating the complexities of the modern world.

2. Story-Based Question

Question: Do you think the third level was real or imaginary? Justify with evidence.

Answer: Introduction: The third level in Jack Finney's story exists at the intersection of imagination and reality, leaving readers to interpret its nature.

Content: Charley's vivid descriptions of the third level, complete with flickering gaslights, old-fashioned attire, and the Currier & Ives locomotive, suggest that it might be a product of his imagination. His psychiatrist's assertion that it is a "waking-dream wish fulfillment" reinforces this view, as Charley subconsciously seeks escape from modern life's pressures. However, the discovery of Sam's letter, postmarked 1894, complicates this perspective. This concrete evidence suggests the possibility of the third level's existence and provides a fascinating twist to the story, leaving the truth ambiguous.

Conclusion: Whether real or imaginary, the third level serves as a metaphor for hope, escapism, and the power of human imagination. It encourages readers to explore how reality and dreams intertwine in their own lives.

3. Character-Based Question

Question: Discuss Charley's character as depicted in *The Third Level*.

Answer: Introduction: Charley, the protagonist of *The Third Level*, is a relatable and multidimensional character who embodies the struggles of modern life.

Content: Charley is portrayed as an ordinary, nostalgic individual searching for peace. His desire to escape to Galesburg, 1894, reflects his longing for simplicity amidst modern life's chaos. His hobbies, like stamp collecting, highlight his deep emotional connection to the past. Charley's vivid imagination and open-mindedness allow him to discover the third level, showing his belief in possibilities beyond the ordinary. At the same time, his interactions with his wife Louisa and his psychiatrist reflect his determination and resilience in facing life's challenges.

Conclusion: Charley's character resonates with readers as a symbol of hope and perseverance. His quest for peace amidst turmoil makes him relatable and inspiring.

4. Theme-Based Question

Question: Explain the theme of escapism in *The Third Level*.

Answer: Introduction: Escapism is a central theme in Jack Finney's *The Third Level*, depicting the human yearning to break free from the anxieties of modern life.

Content: The third level at Grand Central Station symbolizes a metaphorical escape from reality. Charley's longing to return to 1894 reflects his dissatisfaction with the insecurities and worries of the present day. Through his psychiatrist's explanation of "waking-dream wish fulfillment," the story underscores the idea of escapism as a psychological necessity. Sam's choice to stay in Galesburg further illustrates the universal human desire for a stress-free and idyllic existence. By blending fantasy with realistic details, the author presents escapism as both a refuge and a response to life's challenges.

Conclusion: The theme of escapism in the story serves as a reminder of the importance of finding peace and balance in a chaotic world. It also encourages readers to embrace hope and imagination as tools for coping with stress.

5. Article Based

Escaping Reality: Lessons from The Third Level by XYZ

In today's fast-paced world, stress and anxiety often overwhelm our lives. Jack Finney's story *The Third Level* offers a thought-provoking perspective on how individuals cope with such pressures. The story revolves around Charley's discovery of a mysterious third level at Grand Central Station, symbolizing an escape to a peaceful past.

Through Charley's experiences, Finney explores the theme of escapism. The third level and its depiction of 1894 represent the human yearning for simpler, more secure times. The story reminds readers that while escapism can provide temporary relief, it is essential to balance it with practical approaches to life's challenges.

Ultimately, *The Third Level* teaches us that hope, imagination, and hobbies can be powerful tools to combat the modern world's stress. It inspires readers to seek peace within themselves while navigating the complexities of life.

6. Speech Based

Title: *Managing Stress: Finding Balance in Life*

Good morning, everyone.

Stress is an inevitable part of life, but managing it effectively can make all the difference. As highlighted in Jack Finney's *The Third Level*, finding constructive ways to escape stress can restore balance and peace to our lives.

Charley, the protagonist, copes with modern life's insecurities by escaping into his imagination, hobbies, and nostalgia. His journey teaches us that exploring activities like hobbies, spending time with loved ones, and reflecting on the past can help us navigate challenges.

However, it is essential to maintain a balance. While temporary escapism is helpful, we must also face reality with resilience. Practices like mindfulness, organization, and gratitude can help manage stress.

In conclusion, let's embrace healthy coping mechanisms and strive to create a life that balances responsibilities with moments of peace and joy. Thank you.

7. Conversation-Based

Question: Write a conversation between Charley and his psychiatrist about the third level.

Answer: Charley: I found the third level again! I walked through a corridor and saw people dressed in old-fashioned clothes, gaslights, and everything from 1894.

Psychiatrist: Charley, this sounds fascinating, but I believe it reflects your subconscious mind's desire to escape. You mentioned the stress of modern life.

Charley: But it felt so real! The newsboy was selling *The World*, and I saw a Currier & Ives locomotive!

Psychiatrist: That's the power of your imagination. Your mind creates a vivid world to cope with your stress and longing for peace.

Charley: But then how do you explain the letter I found from Sam? It was postmarked 1894!

Psychiatrist: That's certainly intriguing, Charley. Perhaps there's more to this than we understand. But remember, even if it's real or imaginary, what matters is how it helps you find balance and happiness in life.